

28 March 2025

This Insights paper discusses the economic mechanisms by which the hundreds of billions of dollars provided annually in agricultural support contribute to increased emissions, biodiversity loss and soil nutrient imbalances. It also highlights options for alternative support policies and presents real-world examples of improved environmental outcomes stemming from agricultural support removal/reform.

[International farmgate emissions intensity statistics](#)

July 2024

Emissions intensities are useful means to compare the environmental impact of the same activities across different countries. Countries with a lower emissions intensity produce less emissions for the same level of activity than countries with a higher emissions intensity. This page makes available farmgate emissions intensity estimates for different types of agricultural activities across countries.

To advance Australia's strategic multilateral trade liberalisation objectives, Australia has sought to demonstrate the environmental damage caused by agricultural support. Of equal importance, however, is Australia's own agri-environmental performance. This report provides Australian and international officials with an evidence base to show where Australia stands internationally, and how to interpret such statistics appropriately.

[Reforming agricultural markets to support emissions reductions](#)

March 2023

The role that support policies play in either increasing or decreasing global agricultural GHG emissions is attracting greater scrutiny, with several studies pointing to contrasting impacts. However, agriculture is only one part of a broader food system. Not only do agricultural subsidies and tariff protections matter, but so do the trade distortions that impact downstream food production and trade. This report provides technical details on previously published ABARES research used to support Australia's WTO negotiating team to advance Australia's efforts to reduce global trade distortions.

[Emissions, agricultural support and food security](#)

November 2022

Agriculture puts food on tables around the world. It also contributes to global emissions. To meet the global commitment to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, it is essential to seek all avenues for reduction. Agriculture and related land use accounts for around 12% of global emissions. Global agrifood production remains heavily subsidised and protected in many parts of the world, implying that avoidable emissions are subsidised by taxpayers around the world. A reduction in global agrifood subsidies, tariffs and quotas would lead to a recalibration of agrifood production, with implications for emissions. Could the world cut emissions from agrifood production, improve food security and raise global economic growth?

[EU-Australia Farming, One goal but many paths to sustainability](#)

14 Jun 2022

While approaches to sustainability vary between the EU and Australia, both countries have common goals and have made significant efforts to ensure sustainable agricultural production. Australia's key strengths relate to working with the natural environment and not against it, fostered by a policy environment that lets market forces govern sustainable input and land use. Australia's agricultural innovation system is key to improving sustainability outcomes for the sector. This slide pack was shared during a panel event and provides an overview of Australian agriculture's approach to sustainability.

[Mega Trends: Megatrends shaping Australian agriculture \(2021 update\)](#)

Feb 2021

Australia's food and fibre industries will be shaped by multiple interacting changes over the coming decades. These changes will occur at global, national, and local scales. They will create opportunities and challenges for all food and fibre industries and farm businesses. They will also impact on Australian lifestyles, landscapes, communities, and wider society and economy.

In order to better understand these evolving changes, this article updates previous CSIRO analysis (Hajkowicz 2015, Hajkowicz and Eady 2015), setting out five global megatrends that will shape Australian life and choices, and exploring their implications for Australian food and fibre industries to 2040 and beyond.

[ABARES Insights: Opportunities from action on climate change](#)

10 Dec 2020

Climate change and associated policies have important implications for future competitiveness of Australia's agricultural exports, which many agricultural industries are already addressing through ambitious emissions reduction plans. Some of Australia's major agricultural exports are already relatively less emissions intensive than some major competitors providing scope for Australia to further its trade reputation as a reliable and sustainable producer.

This ABARES Insights report concludes that innovation and investment are key to decoupling emissions from agricultural production, and promoting evidence-based trade rules and product certification will help achieve industry goals of emissions reduction and revenue growth.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/abares/research-topics/trade/climate>